STUDENT DIGITAL AMBASSADOR · MODULE 1 · 20 MARKS

Digital Literacy Awareness

More than just using technology — it's about thinking critically,
acting responsibly, and building your presence with purpose.

5B+
INTERNET USERS WORLDWIDE IN 2024

85%
JOBS REQUIRE DIGITAL SKILLS TODAY

DEFINITION — WHAT IS DIGITAL LITERACY?

The ability to **find, evaluate, create, and communicate information** using digital technologies — responsibly, critically, and effectively. It is not just about knowing how to use apps; it is about **thinking before you click**, understanding how digital systems shape your world, and using technology to **add real value** to your academic and professional life.

THE FOUR PILLARS

Find & Evaluate
Search effectively & verify sources before trusting them

Create & Communicate
Produce quality digital content and communicate professionally

Stay Safe & Ethical
Protect your data, respect privacy, and act with integrity

Build Your Brand
Shape a professional, consistent online identity that works for you

CORE TOPICS

01 — SAFETY
Safe Internet Practices

- Use strong passwords + 2FA on every account
- Recognise and avoid phishing emails & links
- Keep all apps and software updated
- Think twice before sharing personal info online
- Avoid public Wi-Fi for sensitive tasks — use VPN
- Check app permissions regularly & revoke unnecessary access

HOW PHISHING WORKS — 4 STEPS

1. **Hook** — Offers something you want
2. **Looks Real** — Fake logos & formal tone
3. **Urgency** — Act within 12 hours!
4. **Steal** — Captures your credentials

02 — PRODUCTIVITY
Useful Digital Tools for Students

- **Research:** Google Scholar, Zotero, Mendeley
- **Writing:** Grammarly, Overleaf, Hemingway Editor
- **Organisation:** Notion, Trello, Google Calendar
- **Collaboration:** Google Drive, Miro, Figma
- **Presentation:** Canva, Prezi, Google Slides
- **Coding & Portfolio:** GitHub, VS Code, Replit

Canva · Notion · GitHub · Grammarly · Zotero · Trello · Miro · Google Drive · Overleaf · ChatGPT

03 — IDENTITY
Professional Online Presence

- **LinkedIn:** Complete profile with photo, bio & skills
- Showcase real projects on GitHub or a portfolio site
- Keep all social media employer-appropriate
- Be consistent — same name/photo across platforms
- Engage in your field — share knowledge, comment thoughtfully
- Remember: digital footprints are **permanent**

WORKS VS BACKFIRES

✓ Works
Skills match what you post. Consistent across platforms. Honest journey shown.

✗ Backfires
Skills don't match. Old poor work still visible. Optimised to look busy.

COMMUNICATION & IMPACT

04 — COMMUNICATION
Email Etiquette

✗ WHAT NOT TO DO

"Hi sir, I need recommendations urgently. Send asap."

Sounds like a demand. No context, no respect, no deadline given.

✓ WHAT TO DO

"Dear Sir, I am applying to [Company] by [date]. Your feedback in [course] speaks directly to what they look for."

Professional, clear, respectful and provides context.

GOLDEN RULES OF EMAIL

- Clear subject line
- Formal greeting
- One topic only
- Proofread first
- Professional signature
- Reply within 48hrs

Why Digital Literacy Matters for You

In numbers — the real impact

92% of employers say digital skills are essential when hiring graduates

3.4B phishing emails sent every single day — awareness is your shield

∞ Your digital footprint is permanent — every post, every click, forever

KEY INSIGHT

"Being online is not the same as understanding the internet. Literacy means judgment, not just access."

THE BOTTOM LINE — REMEMBER THIS

Digital literacy isn't about knowing **more tools.** *It's about* **thinking before you click,** *acting with integrity online, and understanding that your* **digital footprint is permanent.** *Be intentional. Be skilled. Be responsible.*